



use of your solution. What people today commonly refer to as deep tech often causes confusion. The key factor with deep tech is that it involves both high levels of technological innovation and high-value, evident, practical applications, sometimes, multiple application domains. In other words, it is not just about using advanced technology, but also about creating fundamentally new technology with significant real-world use almost immediately.

Here comes the vaccine example. In such cases, relentless scientific research is essential. The problem space is clearly understood, but a solution has not been found yet. For example, another application case is wanting to travel from Delhi to San Francisco in three hours—there is no service now. But, if it existed, there would definitely be a market for it. The challenge is creating it at an affordable price. So you need a sustainable business model combined with technological inventions. That is deep tech—solving a known problem in technology innovation and appropriate execution. The market is clear because the problem already exists and affects many.

How to turn the vision into a venture: raising capital

In my generation—I graduated with an engineering degree in 1980—starting a business in India was extremely difficult. There was no funding, no startup-friendly support system, and licenses were hard to get. People like Dhirubhai Ambani, who began professional life in a petrol pump and built Reliance, were exceptional entrepreneurs. But today, things have significantly improved from the ecosystem perspective. The government is more supportive, more willing investors are visible, and venture capital

is available if you have a good business idea.

The government has also launched the Startup India programme and supports technology business incubators, especially for students. If you have an idea but are unsure about how to start a company or navigate the legalities, joining an incubator is the best step. There are over 1500 incubators in India, both in educational institutions and those run privately. They provide mentors, services, and networks to help you nurture your idea and grow the business model. What matters is having a strong idea with business value.

For those wondering how to register a company or transition from employee to entrepreneur, this is an ideal time to start up in India. With the support of a growing system, it is only getting better.

The leap from employee to entrepreneur: Is it time?

If you are an employee, you essentially exchange your time and expertise for money. The difference in pay across professions is determined by the market. In the past, employees stayed with companies for 30–35 years, not necessarily out of happiness but due to a lack of choice. Today, the scenario is different and there are more opportunities for the talented. If employees are good, they will find jobs.

The future of jobs looks like one professional serving multiple enterprises concurrently, and engaging in competitive collaboration. We can already experience this model in India, especially in the startup community.

Transitioning from employee to entrepreneur starts with financial literacy and stability. If you want to leave your job to start a business, check your personal finances first. How do you manage your

personal wealth? Will you survive for two to three years without a monthly salary? If not, do not start a business. Learn how to manage money first. Thankfully, personal finance is now taught in schools. Learn investing and understand returns. You are not ready to run a business if you do not understand investments. Even business leader jobs in large, well-established companies may not prepare you to design and run your financial system.

Again, if you are not business-savvy but skilled in technology, consider finding a co-founder who handles the business aspects. Once you are financially stable, the idea comes next. A business starts with a problem and offers a solution. You must solve a problem for a human willing to pay for the solution. For instance, your idea cannot be for the manufacturing industry—who in the manufacturing industry suffers the problem you are solving, and is willing and able to purchase your solution?

Problems are not always functional. People buy products for emotional or social reasons too. A Rolex, a Timex, and a mobile phone all show time, but people choose based on needs beyond function, like status or identity. This concept is referred to as the 'job to be done.'

Validate your idea by identifying who has the problem and if they are willing to pay for the solution. Do not build the product first. Listen to the prospective customers about the problem they experience, in the context of your idea and its possible application. For instance, if I built an ultrasound device to detect sugarcane pests, I should first check if farmers face this problem, what they are doing about it now, how much their loss is, and whether they can afford such a solution.

Once you have validated your